

IAS PRELIMS/MAINS

Ecology & Environment

A stylized illustration of a green city skyline with various skyscrapers, wind turbines, and a sun, all set against a light green background with a subtle globe pattern.

A COMPREHENSIVE COVERAGE

MODULE - 12

WETLANDS - 5

WETLANDS (CONSERVATION AND MANAGEMENT) RULES. 2017

The Ministry of Environment, Forests and Climate Change notified the Wetlands (Conservation and Management) Rules, 2017, under the Environment (Protection) Act 1986.

FEATURES OF THE RULES

- **Nodal authority:** As per the Wetlands Rules, the Wetlands Authority within a state is the nodal authority.
- **Functions of the authority:**
 - ✓ Preparing a list of all wetlands in the state/UT and recommending wetlands for regulation under the Rules.
 - ✓ Developing a comprehensive list of activities to be regulated and permitted within the notified wetlands.
 - ✓ Issuing necessary directions for the conservation and sustainable management of wetlands to the respective implementing agencies.

WETLANDS (CONSERVATION AND MANAGEMENT) RULES. 2017

The Ministry of Environment, Forests and Climate Change notified the Wetlands (Conservation and Management) Rules, 2017, under the Environment (Protection) Act 1986.

FEATURES OF THE RULES

Prohibited activities: The following activities are prohibited on wetlands

- ✓ Setting up any industry and expansion of existing industries
- ✓ Dumping solid waste or discharge of untreated wastes and effluents from industries and any human settlements, and
- ✓ Encroachment or conversion for non-wetlands uses.
- **Integrated Management Plan:** The rules recommend the state/UT administration to prepare a plan for the management of each notified wetland. The plan refers to a document which:
- **Enforcing the rules:** The Wetlands Authorities are responsible for ensuring the enforcement of the Wetlands Rules and other relevant acts, rules and regulations.

ESTUARIES

- An estuary is a place where a river or a stream opens into the sea (mouth of the river).
- It is a partially enclosed coastal area of brackish water (semi-saline) with one or more rivers or streams flowing into it.
- At the estuaries, fresh water carrying fertile silt and runoff from the land mixes with the salty sea water.
- Estuaries form a transition zone (ecotone) between river ecosystem and marine ecosystem.
- Estuaries are greatly influenced by tidal action. They are periodically washed by sea water once or twice a day based on the number of tides.
- In some narrow estuaries, tidal bores are significant. Tidal bores cause great damage to the estuarine ecology.



A Tidal Bore occurs along a coast where a river empties into an ocean or sea. A tidal bore is a strong tide that pushes up the river, against the flow of the river.

ESTUARIES



IMPORTANCE OF ESTUARIES

- Thousands of species of birds, mammals, fish (including commercially important varieties) and other wildlife depend on estuarine habitats as places to live, feed and reproduce.
- Estuaries provide ideal areas for migratory birds to rest and feed during their long journeys.
- Also, an estuary has very little wave action, so it provides a calm and protected spawning place for many different aquatic organisms. So, estuaries are often called the 'nurseries of the sea.'
- Estuaries have important commercial value, they facilitate tourism, fisheries and recreational activities.
- The protected coastal waters of estuaries also support critical infrastructure like harbours and ports.
- Estuaries are most heavily populated areas throughout the world, with about 60% of the world's population living along estuaries due to the presence of fertile deltas.
- The economy of many coastal areas is based primarily on the natural beauty and bounty of estuaries. When those natural resources are in danger, the livelihoods of millions of people who depend on them is also endangered.
- The vast mangrove forests in an estuary act as barrier to check the wind speed during cyclones and storm surge.

WE EXPRESS OUR
SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



Learning Space

For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

For Information:

info.learningspacedigital@gmail.com

Visit us at:

www.learningspacedigital.com

0866 244 44 72

98499 42299

94415 27588